LETTER FROM THE EDITOR-IN-CHIEF

Bespoke comfort is the new epicurean luxury, where tailored relaxation and carefully curated spaces have officially replaced swathes of rigid formality. Welcome to the world of the supper club, where the most intimate, coveted and delicious experiences are redefining gourmet dining today. The concept dates back to 19th-century Europe, where intellectuals and artists would gather in private salons to dine and debate. But in India, these privately-hosted dinners in elegant homes reinterpret the ancient Indian tradition of the 'daawat'. These elaborate home feasts do not advertise or allow walk-ins, but are the most talked-about secrets dotting India's culinary landscape.

While in Mumbai's Bandra, it's a 140-year-old building that hosts one the city's most popular supper clubs, in Hyderabad, 78-year-old Dilnaz Baig organises Dastarkhwan-e-Naz, traditional Hyderabadi dinners where CEOs, clebrities and occasionaly even Hollywood actors like Ralph Fiennes, find their way. Incidentally, if not coincidentally, her husband and former first-class cricketer Murtuza Ali Baig, had opened for Oxford University as had Fiennes' own father.

However, it isn't just shared stories about wielding the willow or real conversation that make supper clubs feel luxurious or exclusive. It is the experience of a menu that changes every time, the feeling of being personally welcomed, and not merely attended to, and an eclectic guest list which rarely exceeds 20. This infrastructure of informal gatherings is what Dubai-based Neha Mishra used to build her home supper club, Kinoya, into a world-class dining destination. The restaurant is top ranked in the UAE and no 2 in the Middle East and North Africa's 50 best list.

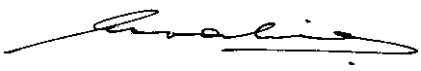
While Mishra's rich, complex ramen bowls and comforting Japanese classics served in a minimalist, fuss-free atmosphere rewrite several rules of the gourmandise set, the rise of the private members' club in India outlines a slightly different architecture for a room. According to a research by Axon Developers in partnership with hospitality consulting company SKYE, the market for private members-only clubs stood at ₹576 crore in 2024 and is projected to reach ₹941 crore by 2027, with a compound annual growth rate of 17.8 per cent spread across more than 25 operational clubs across India's metros. These numbers do not simply reflect on a trend but a structural shift: A third space where curated company, selective application processes and privacy is the ultimate luxury.



The new Bentley Flying Spur is a rocket ship wrapped in luxury

Of course, as far as the subtext of identity is concerned, affiliation is a statement of character, and not just capital. This is why *Spice* chooses the subtle declaration of the new, nature-led and wellness-forward The Leela Coorg Forest Sanctuary to toast Madikeri's finest coffee trails. Unveiled as the toast of the Leela group, which celebrates 40 years, the team has ensured that neither design nor details tidy away the heritage that still allows coffee to remain the Sanctuary's native language.

From the misty hills of Coorg, to flying above the clouds, an interesting evolution in luxury aviation translates to many airlines enhancing business class offerings to phase out first class. With technology, smart design and bespoke customisation outlining travel experiences, the newest iteration of the Bentley Flying Spur is the *Spice* ride of the season. Boasting a V8 powertrain and the world's first 3D machined wood panels, the handcrafted cabin could almost double up as a gentleman's private club. It is the ritual of belonging.



(Aroon Purie)